STARWEAVER®

Hands-On-Learning: Framing Intelligence Problems and Modeling Adversary Impact

Learning Objectives

By the end of this activity, learners will be able to:

- Frame intelligence problems as decision-oriented questions tied to leadership needs, time horizons, and organizational constraints.
- Decompose intelligence questions into supporting analytic components, identifying assumptions and evidence that affect confidence.



- Model adversary behavior by separating capability, intent, and constraint, and structure analysis using MITRE ATT&CK and Centers of Gravity.



Description

In this hands-on activity, learners will practice converting vague leadership concerns into structured, decision-relevant intelligence. Set within the context of an elevated cyber risk scenario, the lab guides learners through framing an intelligence problem, decomposing analytic questions, modeling adversary behavior using MITRE ATT&CK, identifying centers of gravity using Mural, and preparing a leadership-ready intelligence summary. Learners will apply the core Module 1 principle: intelligence is valuable only when it informs decisions.

Structure of the Project

Title: Framing Intelligence Problems and Modeling Adversary Impact

Tools used: MITRE ATT&CK Navigator (open source); Mural (free version) or equivalent whiteboard tool

Scenario

You are part of a threat intelligence team supporting senior leadership during a period of elevated cyber risk. Recent reporting suggests increased activity by a sophisticated adversary, but leadership is struggling to determine whether the information being presented should drive changes in posture, investment, or response priorities. Your task is to move from information to decision-relevant intelligence by framing an intelligence problem, decomposing analytic questions, modeling adversary behavior, and identifying centers of gravity that matter to leadership.

Objective

Your goal is to practice the full upstream intelligence workflow—from problem framing through adversary modeling to leadership communication. This exercise will help you apply structured analytic tradecraft, evaluate how intelligence supports organizational decisions, and produce a defensible intelligence summary under realistic constraints.



Instructions for learners

Task 1 – Frame the Intelligence Problem:

Review the scenario provided.

Write a single intelligence problem statement (2–3 sentences) that identifies a decision owner (e.g., executive leadership), specifies a decision context (e.g., prioritization, posture, investment), and includes a clear time horizon.

Ensure your problem statement is a decision-oriented question, not a topic.

Task 2 – Decompose the Intelligence Question:

Break your intelligence problem into 3–5 supporting analytic questions.

For each supporting question, identify at least one assumption, one type of evidence that would increase confidence, and one type of evidence that would reduce confidence.

Task 3 – Model Adversary Capability, Intent, and Constraint:

Using your decomposed questions, outline what the adversary is capable of doing, what objectives they are likely pursuing, and what constraints might limit their actions.

Explicitly separate capability from intent. Present as a brief adversary model (bullet or table format acceptable).

Task 4 – Structure Analysis Using MITRE ATT&CK:

Open the MITRE ATT&CK Enterprise Matrix.

Identify 2–3 tactics most relevant to your intelligence problem and select specific techniques that help explain how the adversary might pursue their objective.

Note what ATT&CK helps you reason about and what it does not answer.

Task 5 – Identify Centers of Gravity Using Mural:

Open a new Mural board. Create three sections: Adversary Objectives, Target System, and Decision Impact.

Map major system components (not vulnerabilities). Identify one or two Centers of Gravity and justify why they represent leverage points. Connect centers of gravity to leadership-level impacts.

Task 6 – Prepare a Leadership-Ready Intelligence Summary:

Draft a short intelligence summary (no more than one page) that states the intelligence judgment, includes an explicit confidence level, explains what would change your assessment, and avoids technical overload.

Focus on choices and consequences, not raw findings.

Organize Information Following This Structure for Peer Review:

1. **Intelligence Problem Statement:** Your decision-oriented intelligence question (2–3 sentences).
2. **Decomposed Analytic Questions:** Supporting questions with assumptions and evidence notes.
3. **Adversary Model:** Brief model separating capability, intent, and constraint.
4. **ATT&CK-Based Analytic Summary:** Relevant tactics/techniques and reasoning gaps identified.
5. **Centers of Gravity Analysis:** Mural board screenshot/export with 1–2 paragraph explanation.

6 **Leadership Intelligence Brief:** One-page summary with judgment, confidence level, and conditions for reassessment.

Instructions for Documenting and Sharing the Project for Peer Review

1. Document the Project

- Use word processing software to create your intelligence brief and supporting analysis.
- Ensure all sections of the project document structure are completed.

Proofread and edit your submission for clarity, analytic rigor, and accuracy.

2. Share the Project



Save your report and any Mural exports in PDF format.

Upload your documents to the "Peer Review" area in the course shell.

Provide a brief description of your project in the submission post.

3. Peer Review

- Review the projects submitted by your peers.
- Provide constructive feedback and comments on their work.

This activity gives learners a chance to apply Module 1 principles by moving from vague concerns to structured, decision-relevant intelligence—reinforcing that intelligence is valuable only when it informs decisions.